



A HOMEOWNER'S HANDBOOK • NEW YORK CITY

Your Guide to a *Successful* Remodel

*A clear, honest walkthrough of the renovation process —
from first conversation to final walkthrough.*

PROVEN SOLUTIONS USA

Licensed & Insured General Contracting

A SHORT, HONEST GUIDE

The right remodel starts with the *right* *conversation.*

Most renovation problems don't start on the job site. They start before the work begins — in how the project is scoped, priced, and agreed upon.

This is a short guide for the homeowners and property managers we meet every week in New York. No jargon, no upsell — just what to ask, what to expect, and how to protect what you're building. Read it once, then keep it nearby.

With care,

THE PROVEN SOLUTIONS TEAM

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- I.* Why Scope Matters
 - II.* Choosing a Contractor
 - III.* Understanding the Estimate

- IV.* The Deposit & Contract
- V.* During the Project
- VI.* After the Project

FOUNDATIONS

Get the *basics* right.



I. Why the Scope Matters Before Anything Starts [Blueprint]

Before anyone gives you a number, decide what's being built. The scope is the room-by-room list of what's included — and what's not. Without it, every estimate is a guess and every comparison is meaningless.

One hour spent defining the scope today saves a week of arguments later.



II. How to Choose the Right Contractor [Shield]

Licensed and insured means two real things: a license number you can verify with the city, and active general liability plus workers' comp. A serious contractor sends both without hesitation — ask for them in writing.

GREEN FLAGS

- + License & insurance up front
- + Written scope before any quote
- + Local references you can call

RED FLAGS

- A number without seeing the space
- Cash-only or full payment up front
- Same-day signing pressure



CHAPTER THREE [DOCUMENT]

Understanding *the Estimate*

A vague estimate is the prelude to a vague project. Three things every homeowner should know before signing anything – and the questions that protect you.

01 Know the going rate per square foot.

Always ask: "How much per square foot, installed?" It's the fastest way to test whether a quote is honest. A rough range for flooring (materials + labor, before extras):

Luxury vinyl plank	\$4–8 / sq ft
Engineered hardwood	\$6–12 / sq ft
Solid hardwood	\$8–15 / sq ft

Removal of the old floor, underlayment, transitions, and baseboards add \$1–2 / sq ft. Stairs are billed per step. In Manhattan, add 10–20%. If a number sits far outside the range – high or low – ask why. The answer tells you everything.

02 Painting pricing flips at three rooms.

Up to three rooms, painters usually quote per room. Beyond that, the math switches to square footage – that's when you should start asking for a per-square-foot rate. Two more things worth knowing: standard white is always the cheapest finish, and any custom color adds a tinting surcharge plus, often, a second coat.

03 A designer pays for themselves.

One paid session with an interior designer almost always saves more than it costs. They don't just help the space make sense – they prevent costly mistakes in finishes and layout, know which materials look luxe without being luxury-priced, and source smarter than most homeowners can on their own.

THE WORK

From paperwork to *the final key*.



IV. The Deposit & the Contract [Signed Contract]

A deposit isn't a red flag — it's how contractors block time and order materials. The red flag is the size and the schedule. Pay against progress, never against promises. Your contract should put scope, price, schedule, change-order rules, and warranty terms in one signed document.



V. During the Project [Tools]

Know your single point of contact from day one. Every change in scope or cost is written, priced, and signed off before the work happens — never on a handshake, never on "we'll figure it out at the end."



VI. After the Project [Key]

A real ending is a walkthrough with a written punch list, a final invoice that matches the contract, and a folder with warranties, paint codes, and appliance manuals. A serious contractor still answers the phone a year later.

LET'S BUILD SOMETHING RIGHT

Ready to talk about *your* *project?*

Whether it's a single bathroom or a full building, the first conversation is always free — and we'll bring the same honesty you just read about to your kitchen table.

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Building trust, one project at a time